

What *does* matter is picking **markets where your skill (stats + modeling) actually helps**. If your goal is building an app and finding value, these are the best MLB betting angles right now:

Best MLB markets for finding an edge (ranked)

1. Pitcher strikeouts (your best starting point)

This is the **cleanest stats-driven market**.

Why it's best:

- Strong relationship between stats → outcome
- Easy to model (Poisson works well)
- Less “random chaos” than hits or runs
- Books are often slightly off on innings expectations

Best angles:

- Over/under Ks (main line)
- Alt strikeout lines (6.5, 7.5, 8.5)
- Live betting after 2–3 innings

 This is exactly what your app idea should start with.

2. First 5 innings betting (F5)

Instead of full game outcomes.

Why it's good:

- Removes bullpen randomness
- More pitcher vs lineup focused
- Easier to model than full game spreads

Examples:

- F5 under/over runs
 - F5 moneyline
 - F5 team totals
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3. Team totals (runs scored)

Instead of picking winners.

Why it works:

- You only model one team's offense vs pitcher
- Less variance than full game bets

Example:

- "Yankees team total over 4.5"
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4. NRFI / YRFI (No Run First Inning)

Very popular market.

Why it's interesting:

- Pure pitcher + top-of-lineup matchup
 - High variance but modelable with:
 - leadoff OBP
 - pitcher first-inning ERA
 - strikeout rate
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Avoid (if you're trying to build an edge system)

These are harder to model accurately:

- Exact scores
- Full game moneylines (too many variables)
- Home run props (very volatile)

- ❌ Same-game parlays (book holds edge)
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If your goal is “best betting strategy right now”

The smartest simple focus is:

Pitcher Strikeouts + F5 unders

Because:

- Pitchers dominate early innings
 - Strikeout stats are stable
 - Books misprice innings projections
 - Weather + umpire + lineup matter (your model can use this)
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If you want a “starter system” for your app

Build this first:

Step 1

Predict:

- Expected innings
- Expected strikeouts

Step 2

Compute:

- Over/under probability (Poisson model)

Step 3

Compare:

- Your fair odds vs sportsbook odds

Step 4

Only show bets when:

- Edge $\geq$ 3–5%
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Simple truth (important)

Most profitable bettors in MLB are not picking winners.

They are:

finding small pricing errors in **pitcher props and early-game markets**

If you want, I can help you design:

- a **real MVP app you can code in 1–2 days**
- or a **model that predicts strikeouts better than sportsbooks**
- or even a **data pipeline that auto-scrapes MLB stats + odds**

Just tell me how technical you want to go.